for the country's economic growth on a self- accelerating growth. Nehru carried through this basic strategy of planned development. Nehru's contribution to the advancement of science, research, technology and industrial development cannot be forgotten. It was during his period, many IITs and Research Institutions were established. He always insited on "scientific temper".

c. Democratic Socialism

Socialism is another contribution of Nehru to India. He put the country on the road towards a socialistic pattern of society. But Nehru's socialism is democratic socialism.

7.8.4 B. R. Ambedkar



B. R. Ambedkar (1891-1956) was a versatile personality. He was the architect of the Indian Constitution, a custodian of social justice and a champion of socialism and state planning. Ambedkar's writings included "Ancient Indian Commerce" (a thesis submitted to the Columbia University for the award of the Master of Arts Degree in 1915), 'National Dividend of India: A Historical and Analytical Study (a thesis for which he was awarded Ph.D). His thesis was published as 'The Evolution of Provincial Finance in British India: A Study of the Provincial Decentralization of Imperial Finance".

Ambedkar's thesis on "Provincial Decentralization of Imperial Finance in British India" was accepted for the M.Sc degree in 1921. And his thesis" The Problem of the Rupee" was accepted for the award of the D.Sc degree by the London School of Economics in 1923. It is a miracle that RBI was conceptualized as per the guidelines presented by Ambedkar in his book, "The Problem of the Rupee;Its origin and its solution". The main economic ideas of Ambedkar may be studied under four broad headings:

1. **Financial Economics**

   Much of the work done by Ambedkar during his stay abroad mostly during the period 1913-1923, was in the field of Finance Economics. Ambedkar divided the evolution of provisional finance into three stages: (i). Budget by Assignment (1871-72 to 1876-77); (ii) Budget by Assigned Revenue (1877-78 to 1881-82); and (iii) Budget by Shared Revenues (1882-83 to 1920-1921).

2. **Agricultural Economics**

   In 1918, Ambedkar published a paper "Small Holding in India and their Remedies". Citing Adam Smith's 'Wealth of Nations", he made a fine distinction between "Consolidation of Holdings" and "Enlargement of Holdings".

3. **Economics of Caste**

   Ambedkar believed that caste was an obstacle to social mobility. It resulted in social stratification. He was of the firm view that individuals must be free to change their occupations. Moreover, the caste system caused social tensions. The caste system has resulted in the absence of social democracy in India as distinct from political democracy.

Chapter-07.indd 157 1/2/2023 11:50:44 AM